

2.0 48-HOUR PSPS NOTIFICATION

This phase begins when the 48-hour notification that a PSPS is going to occur is distributed by electric utilities.

2.1 Generators and Backup Power

Checklist	Notes
☐ Review “Blue Sky” plans.	
☐ Check phase and rotation of generators.	<i>The generator and any motors it powers, should rotate in the same direction.</i>
☐ Verify generator locations.	
☐ Notify staff to be prepared and assign staff for the transport, installation and operation of generators.	<i>Schedules may need to be modified.</i>
☐ Contact agencies and vendors to confirm availability of generators.	
☐ Deploy portable generators with locks.	<i>Prepare contingency equipment and security.</i>
☐ Ensure generators are properly grounded.	
☐ Once the generator is in place, conduct a field test.	<i>Retest the generator under load.</i>
☐ Start generators at least one to two hours before the shut-off and confirm operability and transfer loads.	<i>This will help to prevent issues like water hammer if the power goes out before your generators are on.</i>
☐ Start usage log and establish tracking system for equipment issues.	
☐ Know cycle time, recovery time and water use in each pressure zone.	<i>This is important for wastewater utilities that do not have backup power to prevent overflowing tanks at lift stations.</i>
☐ Secure electrician availability.	

2.2 Fuel

Checklist	Notes
☐ Confirm fuel contracts are in place with vendors and/or suppliers and initiate deliveries as appropriate.	• Stock up and stage fuel, if possible. • Maximum delivery tank size on a non-placarded utility vehicle is 119 gallons.

Checklist	Notes
☐ Confirm partnerships with other agencies that could help to procure fuel.	
☐ Schedule refill of generators based on the fuel consumption worksheet (i.e., burn rate).	<i>Review previous PSPS event (or other power outage) generator burn rates.</i>
☐ Confirm site access for fuelers and refuelers.	<i>For example, spare keys and alarms.</i>
☐ Perform operational checks of fueling equipment.	
☐ Perform assessment of critical sites.	<i>Confirm which sites will be prioritized for fuel if fuel supplies are limited.</i>
☐ Top off the fuel system and polish fuel as required.	<i>Fuel system is defined as fuel storage, generators, and tanks.</i>
☐ Increase storage.	• Explore options to rent on-site fuel storage. • Determine mobility of storage in case you want to move tanks between locations.
☐ Dedicate a centralized fuel delivery point for the vendor/supplier.	• Use smaller utility trucks to transport fuel within the property to specific sites. • Verify utility truck delivery capabilities.
☐ Verify transfer pumps have power redundancy.	
☐ Issue fuel payment methods to staff.	<i>For example, credit cards.</i>
☐ Consider what type of fuel your generators need.	<i>For example, natural gas, diesel, or propane.</i>
☐ Conserve fuel by connecting a programmable logic controller (PLC) to your generators.	<i>The generators will only engage when pumps are about to come on.</i>

2.3 Communication

2.3.1 Internal

Checklist	Notes
☐ Hold staff refresher trainings on the communication SOP and review the communication elements in the ERP.	



Checklist	Notes
☐ Make sure “backup” communication resources and procedures are ready and everyone knows what they are.	<i>Identify a fail safe method and procedure (e.g., meet at this location at this time) if all forms of normal communication go down.</i>
☐ Initiate the internal communications procedure and call tree.	<i>Follow incident command system (ICS) structure or other chain-of-command.</i>
☐ Make sure the “administrator of the day” is notified as well as crew staff (on standby).	
☐ Perform field communications checks.	
☐ Distribute handheld and other radio communication devices as needed.	

2.3.2 Partners

Checklist	Notes
☐ Confirm external contacts are correct and up to date.	<i>For example, CalWARN, local county OES, EOC, public safety, fire and police/dispatch, fuel companies, DDW, public information officers (PIOs) and customers.</i>

2.3.3 External

Checklist	Notes
☐ Communicate with customers to let them know what is happening, what may happen and, if necessary, to plan accordingly and conserve.	<i>Could use systems like Nixle, NextDoor, social media, AlertSolano, websites, and emails.</i>
☐ Prepare boil water notices and “do not drink” notices and have DDW review as necessary.	
☐ Prepare consistent messaging.	• <i>Develop scripts for staff answering phones, communication staff, and field staff.</i> • <i>Consider Message Mapping, and Crisis and Emergency Risk Communication (CERC) protocols.</i>

2.4 Partnerships

Checklist	Notes
☐ Confirm the electric utility has a list of your critical facility locations.	
☐ Determine if the county EOC is activated and if there is a water desk/WSSP.	
☐ Contact rental companies/vendors to reserve fuel, generators and other resources.	
☐ Review mutual aid and assistance agreements.	
☐ Inform partners, including CalWARN, that assistance may be needed and verify availability of resources.	<i>Resource requests could include replacement or additional personnel, equipment or supplies, such as fuel.</i>
☐ Notify high volume customers to conserve water.	<i>High-volume customers include irrigation districts.</i>
☐ Coordinate with sewer system partners regarding water conservation notices.	<i>Conservation helps to reduce the load on PSPS-challenged sewer systems and helps avoid sewer spills. A consistent conservation message from both utilities will be more effective.</i>
☐ Obtain additional security guards, if needed.	<i>Ask law enforcement if they can provide additional security or increase frequency of patrols.</i>
☐ Make arrangements with food establishments and appoint a designated food runner.	<i>For example, caterers, restaurants (within and outside impacted area).</i>

2.5 SCADA

Checklist	Notes
☐ Backup data and print out key information, action lists and information.	
☐ Record or take a screenshot of set points for any equipment that may have power interruptions during the transfer between grid and backup power and vice versa.	
☐ Test all alarms and make sure set points are correct.	<i>For example, generator and wet well level.</i>
☐ Alter set points for a larger operating range.	
☐ Prioritize powering a portion of SCADA system that must be operational.	



Checklist	Notes
☐ Review SOPs to refresh staff on how to manually operate pumps.	
☐ Confirm that SCADA support vendor information and contacts are up to date.	
☐ Put instrument technician on standby.	
☐ Switch all but one pump to manual ("singling up").	<i>When backup power goes on, not all the pumps turn back on and you avoid overloading your generator.</i>
☐ Ensure there is "defensible space" clear of brush and debris around any repeater.	
☐ Conduct a pre- and post-inspection of the facility, including PLCs.	• <i>Know system settings before the PSPS and after; make sure they are the same.</i> • <i>If there was a power surge, make sure electronics are working correctly.</i>
☐ Expect minimal SCADA communication while on generator power.	

2.6 Staffing

Checklist	Notes
☐ Place your emergency response staff on stand-by and establish chain of command.	
☐ Determine availability of staff for 24/7 coverage.	• <i>Roles and responsibilities may have to be modified.</i> • <i>Notify all staff of these modifications.</i> • <i>Identify employees who live in potentially PSPS affected areas.</i>
☐ Conduct an "all hands" coordination meeting to explain potential new job duties and expectations.	• <i>Provide consistent messaging.</i> • <i>Inform staff if there are any expected changes in operation, assignments, contacts or schedules.</i>
☐ Plan to activate your DOC.	
☐ Encourage staff to prepare themselves, their families and their homes for a PSPS event.	
☐ Prepare for staff deployment by "setting up and stocking up".	<i>For example, prepare lodging, food, water and sleeping facilities.</i>



Checklist	Notes
☐ Increase on-call staffing, especially for specialized crews, such as generator set-up crews.	
☐ Keep track of receipts and overtime hours.	<i>Keep accurate cost and time records. Reimbursement may be available later, especially if a disaster is declared by state or federal government.</i>
☐ Consider giving more staff purchasing capability.	<i>Potentially increase the limits on purchase order authorizations and agency credit cards.</i>
☐ Conduct "just in time" training/refreshers as needed.	<i>For example, on generator hookup.</i>

2.7 Access

Checklist	Notes
☐ Check facility sites and address any immediate access issues.	<i>For example, leaves, branches and potholes.</i>
☐ Have a back-up plan if roads become inaccessible.	• <i>How will staff reach the facility if there is limited to no access?</i> • <i>Identify dedicated tree personnel for clearing downed trees.</i>
☐ Verify staff and vehicles have proper credentials.	
☐ Identify contacts within the EOC for this event, such as the transportation contact.	<i>It is likely that your local EOC is at least partially activated.</i>
☐ Identify staff access roles and their contact information.	
☐ Identify critical water facilities on a map. Use GIS layers to support.	<i>For example, critical level 1/level 2 or high, medium and low.</i>
☐ Contact your electric utility for the exact power shut off locations and deploy staff and resources accordingly.	<i>Consider facility criticality. If possible, use hydraulic modeling and analysis to assess changes in service levels corresponding to the shutdown plan. Also, deploying staff early will help to avoid any future access issues that may arise post-PSPS.</i>
☐ Consider and weigh factors for access needs.	<i>For example, weather vs. deployment time vs. critical facility vs. other factors.</i>
☐ Start monitoring for access changes.	<i>For example, road closures due to wildfire spread or pattern.</i>

2.8 Safety

Checklist	Notes
☐ Review health and safety plans and send out reminders to staff.	<i>Conduct "walk-throughs" regarding high voltage/arc flash safety training.</i>
☐ Review and implement safety SOPs as appropriate.	
☐ Review the ERP, including its contact list.	
☐ Coordinate regular safety meetings.	<i>This could be done through the ICS planning process.</i>
☐ Identify what personal protective equipment (PPE) and other equipment are needed and pre-stage equipment.	<i>Confirm you have enough PPE and it is all up to date.</i>

3.0 ZERO HOUR POWER OUT

This phase occurs as soon as the PSPS is initiated and grid power is shut off.

3.1 Generators and Backup Power

Checklist	Notes
☐ Verify that generators have initiated and are running correctly.	
☐ Confirm that pumps have pressure.	

3.2 Fuel

Checklist	Notes
☐ Manually check levels of fuel storage.	

3.3 Communication

3.3.1 Internal

Checklist	Notes
☐ Verify two-way radios are operating correctly.	
☐ Confirm batteries are working in communication devices.	
☐ Complete a general check of communication system(s).	<i>Even if you checked at the 48-hour PSPS notification while the power was still on, some systems may not be working as expected on back-up power.</i>

3.3.2 Partners

Checklist	Notes
☐ Perform a communication check.	<i>Although you verified contact information earlier, means of communication may have changed since the power shut off.</i>

3.3.3 External

Checklist	Notes
☐ Notify customers that the utility is operating on backup power due to the PSPS.	

3.4 Partnerships

Checklist	Notes
☐ Complete a general check of partner communication systems.	• Even if you checked at the 48-hour PSPS notification while the power was still on, some systems may not be working as expected on back-up power.
☐ Verify that there are no discrepancies within your electric utility's on-line information portal.	• For example, the portal incorrectly indicates that your facility has grid power. • If there is a discrepancy, reach out to your electric utility.

3.5 SCADA

Checklist	Notes
☐ Attend to all active SCADA alarms.	• Verify that everything is working as it should. • Reset SCADA alarms.

3.6 Staffing

Checklist	Notes
☐ Determine staffing needs and begin modified schedule.	
☐ Identify employees that are living in areas affected by the PSPS and adjust schedule, if needed.	

3.7 Access

Checklist	Notes
☐ Verify that electronic access control systems are working correctly without grid power.	<i>For example, make sure key cards are still working and you can get in/out.</i>



3.6 Safety

Checklist	Notes
☐ Confirm PPE is in place.	
☐ Verify everyone understands proper SOPs for safety.	